

Lesson 21: “Looking Forth for the Great Day of the Lord to Come” (See L21 [Class Member Study Guide](#))

Purpose: To help us understand and recognize the signs of the Second Coming and prepare for “the great day of the Lord to come” (D&C 45:39).

1. The Savior will return to the earth in power and great glory.

We “are privileged to live in the dispensation of the fullness of times, when latter-day revelation teaches us great truths about the Second Coming, the events that will precede it, and the thousand years of peace that will begin when the Savior comes again. The Doctrine and Covenants provides a wealth of information on these important subjects.

“Just as every prophecy relating to the Savior’s birth was fulfilled, so too will every prophecy relating to His Second Coming be fulfilled.” (*Lesson Manual*)

- D&C 29:9-11; 45:44. “For the hour is nigh ... and all the proud and they that do wickedly shall be as stubble”.
- D&C 34:7-8, 11-12; 43:17. The “time is soon at hand that I shall come in a cloud with power and great glory.”
- D&C 45:44-54; 88:96-99. An “angel shall sound his trumpet, and the saints that have slept shall come forth”.
- D&C 49:6. The Son of Man “will reign till he descends on the earth to put all enemies under his feet”.
- D&C 59:7. The “hour and the day no man knoweth, neither the angels in heaven”.
- D&C 133:46-53. The “Lord shall be red in his apparel.” This is His “day of vengeance” on the wicked.

“24 Behold, vengeance cometh speedily upon the inhabitants of the earth, a day of wrath, a day of burning, a day of desolation, of weeping, of mourning, and of lamentation; and as a whirlwind it shall come upon all the face of the earth, saith the Lord.

“25 And upon my house shall it begin, and from my house shall it go forth, saith the Lord;

“26 First among those among you who have professed to know my name and have not known me, and have blasphemed against me in the midst of my house, saith the Lord.” (D&C 112)

2. The Millennium will be a time of joy and peace.

“The Savior’s Second Coming will usher in the thousand-year period called the Millennium. The tenth article of faith declares that during this time, “Christ will reign personally upon the earth,” and the earth will be renewed and receive its paradisiacal glory. Doctrine and Covenants 101 provides a description of the beauty and joy we can look forward to during the Millennium.” (*Lesson Manual*)

†1. The Millennium

How can this knowledge about the Millennium be a blessing in our lives now?

How does it help you to know that righteousness will eventually triumph over wickedness?

3. We must prepare for the Second Coming.

“The Lord has repeatedly emphasized that we must prepare for His coming (D&C 133:4, 10-11). Some people may feel that they can never do enough or be good enough to prepare adequately. They may become discouraged and feel that such preparation is impossible. However, the Lord has given counsel in the Doctrine and Covenants to teach us that we can prepare for this important event as part of our daily lives.” (*Lesson Manual*)

What can we do in our lives today to prepare for the Second Coming?

In “the Doctrine and Covenants, the Lord reveals many of the signs that will precede His Second Coming and encourages us to ‘be watchful’ (D&C 61:38). (*Lesson Manual*)

- D&C 45:36-39. When “they shall see all these things, then shall they know that the hour is nigh.”
- Why is it important for us to know the signs that will precede the Savior’s Second Coming?

What are some of the signs prophesied to precede the Savior’s Second Coming?

†2. Positive and Negative Signs

†3. Elder Neal A. Maxwell

†4. President Gordon B. Hinckley

†5. Elder David A. Bednar

†6. Elder Boyd K. Packer

†7. President Spencer W. Kimball

Next Week: L22: The Word of Wisdom: “A Principle with Promise”; See L22 [Class Member Study Guide](#).

(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [Doctrine and Covenants Manual: Religion 324 and 325](#).) † •

†1. The Millennium.

- a. D&C 101:23. (Everyone will see the Savior.)
- b. D&C 101:24. (All the wicked will be destroyed.)
- c. D&C 101:25. (The earth will become new.)
- d. D&C 101:26. (People and animals live in peace.)
- e. D&C 101:27. (People granted righteous desires.)
- f. D&C 101:28. (Satan will not have power to tempt.)
- g. D&C 101:29. (There will be no sorrow or death.)
- h. D&C 101:30-31. (In the twinkling of an eye.)
- i. D&C 101:32-34. (All things shall be revealed.)
- j. D&C 45:58. (Children shall grow up without sin.)
- k. D&C 45:59. (The Lord will be King and Lawgiver.)

†2. Positive and Negative signs:

Positive Signs

- a. D&C 45:9. (The fullness of gospel to be restored.)
- b. D&C 45:66-71. (The New Jerusalem will be built.)
- c. D&C 65:2-6. (God's kingdom will be established.)
- d. D&C 110:11-16. (Priesthood keys will be restored.)
- e. D&C 133:8-9. (Gospel preached throughout world.)

Negative Signs

- a. D&C 29:15. (Men's hearts will fail them.)
- b. D&C 29:16. (Famines, scourges, and desolation.)
- c. D&C 34:9. (Signs and wonders in the heavens.)
- d. D&C 45:26. (Wars, rumors of wars, commotion.)
- e. D&C 45:27. (Love of men becomes cold, iniquity.)
- f. D&C 45:33. (Earthquakes, tempests, tidal waves.)

†3. **Elder Neal A. Maxwell:** "And, if you sense that one day every knee shall bow and every tongue shall confess that Jesus Christ is the Lord, why not do so now? For in the coming of that collective confession, it will mean much less to kneel down when it is no longer possible to stand up!" ("[Why Not Now?](#)" *Ensign*, Nov. 1974, 13)

†4. **President Gordon B. Hinckley:** "How do you prepare for the Second Coming? Well, you just do not worry about it. You just live the kind of life that if the Second Coming were to be tomorrow you would be ready. Nobody knows when it is going to happen.... Our responsibility is to prepare ourselves, to live worthy of the association of the Savior, to deport ourselves in such a way that when we would not be embarrassed if He were to come among us. That is a challenge in this day and age" (*Church News*, 2 Jan. 1999, 2).

†5. **Elder David A. Bednar:** "Testimony is the beginning of and a prerequisite to continuing conversion. Testimony is a point of departure; it is not an ultimate destination. Strong testimony is the foundation upon which conversion is established.

"Testimony alone is not and will not be enough to protect us in the latter-day storm of darkness and evil in which we are living. Testimony is important and necessary but not sufficient to provide the spiritual strength and protection we need. Some members of the

Church with testimonies have wavered and fallen away. Their spiritual knowledge and commitment did not measure up to the challenges they faced. ("[Converted unto the Lord](#)," *Ensign*, Nov. 2012, 106.

†6. **Elder Boyd K. Packer:** "Teenagers also sometimes think, 'What's the use? The world will soon be blown all apart and come to an end.' That feeling comes from fear, not from faith. No one knows the hour or the day (see [D&C 49:7](#)), but the end cannot come until all of the purposes of the Lord are fulfilled. Everything that I have learned from the revelations and from life convinces me that there is time and to spare for you to carefully prepare for a long life. ("[To Young Women and Men](#)," *Ensign*, May 1989, 59)

†7. **President Spencer W. Kimball:** "In the parable, oil can be purchased at the market. In our lives the oil of preparedness is accumulated drop by drop in righteous living. Attendance at sacrament meetings adds oil to our lamps, drop by drop over the years. Fasting, family prayer, home teaching, control of bodily appetites, preaching the gospel, studying the scriptures—each act of dedication and obedience is a drop added to our store. Deeds of kindness, payment of offerings and tithes, chaste thoughts and actions, marriage in the covenant for eternity—these, too, contribute importantly to the oil with which we can at midnight refuel our exhausted lamps" (*Faith Precedes the Miracle*, [1972], 256).

Recommended Reading:

1. Elder Dallin H. Oaks, "[Preparation for the Second Coming](#)," *Ensign*, May 2004, 7.
2. Bishop Dean M. Davies, "[A Sure Foundation](#)," *Ensign*, May 2013, 9-11.
3. Elder Kevin W. Pearson, "[Improving Your Personal Prayers](#)," *Ensign*, June 2013, 36-39.
4. Elder David A. Bednar, "[Converted unto the Lord](#)," *Ensign*, Nov. 2012, 106. ("oil of conversion")
5. Elder Dallin H. Oaks, "[The Challenge to Become](#)," *Ensign*, Nov. 2000 .
6. Nancy Jensen, LDS Gospel Doctrine Plus: D&C L21 "[Looking Forth for the Great Day of the Lord to Come](#)," accessed May 31, 2013.

Recommended Videos:

1. "[Be Not Troubled](#)" (5:14)
2. "[They That Are Wise](#)" (8:43)

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Enrichment Resources:

Elder Dallin H. Oaks: “We need to make both temporal and spiritual preparation for the events prophesied at the time of the Second Coming. And the preparation most likely to be neglected is the one less visible and more difficult—the spiritual. A 72-hour kit of temporal supplies may prove valuable for earthly challenges, but, as the foolish virgins learned to their sorrow, a 24-hour kit of spiritual preparation is of greater and more enduring value” (“[Preparation for the Second Coming](#),” *Ensign*, May 2004, 9).

Elder Kevin W. Pearson: “Our personal prayers are a barometer of our spiritual strength and an indicator of our spiritual well-being...

“What would listening to your personal prayers reveal about you and your relationship with Heavenly Father? ...

“To pray is to speak with God, the Eternal Father of our spirits—not at Him but with Him...

“... Prayer is an essential and enabling spiritual link between God and man. Without prayer, there is no possible return to the Father. Without prayer, sufficient faith to understand and keep the commandments is impossible. Without prayer, the necessary spiritual power to avoid temptation and overcome trials and adversity would be unavailable. Without prayer, repentance, forgiveness and the cleansing power of the Atonement are unavailable...” (“[Improving Your Personal Prayers](#),” *Ensign*, June 2013, 36-37).

D&C 34:7-12. “I Come Quickly”

President Joseph Fielding Smith: “‘I come quickly.’ This is a scriptural expression that occurs frequently, especially in the book of Revelation. This is ‘speaking after the manner of the Lord.’ (D. & C. 63:53.) This does not mean that immediately the Lord will make his appearance, but when he does come he will come suddenly, when he is least expected. He told his disciples that the day would come when men were unawares, as the thief in the night. For this reason we should watch and pray, ‘For as a snare shall it come on all them that dwell on the face of the whole earth.’ (Luke 21:34-35.) There is no excuse for any of us, then, not to be prepared, for we have been fully and frequently warned.” (*Church History and Modern Revelation*, 1:157.)

Enrichment H in the Appendix gives a further treatment of the events associated with the Second Coming. (In *DC Student Manual, Religion 324 and 325*, 70)

D&C 88:99. “What Is the “Redemption of Those Who Are Christ’s at His Coming: Who Have Received Their Part in Prison?”

DC Student Manual: “This passage is a reference to the resurrection of terrestrial beings. After the celestial resurrection, ‘after the Lord and the righteous who are caught up to meet him have descended upon the earth, there will come to pass another resurrection. This may be considered as a part of the first, although it comes later. In this resurrection will come forth those of the terrestrial order, who were not worthy to be caught up to meet him, but who are worthy to come forth and to enjoy the millennial reign....

“ ‘This other class, which will also have right to the first resurrection, are those who are not members of the Church of the Firstborn, but who have led honorable lives, although they refused to accept the fullness of the gospel.

“ ‘Also in this class will be numbered those who died without law and hence are not under condemnation for a violation of the commandments of the Lord.’” (Smith, *Doctrines of Salvation*, 2:296-97. (In *DC Student Manual, Religion 324 and 325*, 204)

D&C 133:46-51. “Why Will the Lord Wear Red Clothing at the Second Coming?”

DC Student Manual: “ ‘In ancient times in some parts of the world, people used to squeeze the juice out of the grapes by placing the grapes in a wine vat and then stomping on them. Naturally, the clothes of those persons who “treadeth in the wine-vat” were soon stained with the grape juice and became the same color. When the Savior appears in the last days, his garments will be red “like him that treadeth in the wine-vat” (D&C 133:48), and “his voice shall be heard: I have trodden in the wine-press alone” (D&C 133:50).’ (Ludlow, *Companion*, 1:678.)

“Wine in Doctrines and Covenants 133:48-51, as in the sacrament, suggests blood, both Christ’s blood when He worked out the Atonement alone, and the blood of vengeance on the wicked at the Second Coming (see Isaiah 64:1-6). President Joseph Fielding Smith said that ‘Isaiah has pictured this great day when the Lord shall come with his garments, or apparel, red and glorious, to take vengeance on the ungodly. (Isa. 64:1-6.) This will be a day of mourning to the wicked, but a day of gladness to all who have kept his commandments. Do not let anyone think that this is merely figurative language, it is literal, and as surely as we live that day of wrath will come when the cup of iniquity is full.’” (*Church History and Modern Revelation*, 1:191-92. In *DC Student Manual, Religion 324 and 325*, 341-42)